View Split Screen Collapse Threads

All Search entries or author... Oldest First

Due Jul 6 11:59pm Available from Jun 30 until Jul 7 3 points possible

7 Replies, 7 Unread

Acting

# Discussion

***My Week with Marilyn* (Simon Curtis, 2011)**

***Initial post is DUE by [Sunday 7/6 at 11:59pm]. Reply post(s) due by [Sunday 7/6 at 11:59pm].***

## Purpose

The end of the chapter on "Acting" in *Looking at Movies* focuses primarily on the acting of Michelle Williams in *Blue Valentine*. Barsam and Monahan note the production details of the film in an effort to shed light on the naturalistic

performances of Williams and her co-star Ryan Gosling. Although the analysis is useful, our discussion this week focuses on how the perception or reception of acting is affected by cinematography and mise-en-scène.

## Instructions

For your **Initial Discussion Post** due by Sunday 7/6 at 11:59pm, please respond to the following prompt below in a post of at least 300 words. You do not have to address every detail of the prompt, but your post should contribute to the discussion and not merely repeat what has already been posted by your classmates. While I encourage you to offer your personal views of the films in this Module, **please refrain from unproductive summaries of story or plot and/or why a film is "good" or "bad."** Assume that everyone in the discussion group has completed the viewing assignment and understands the story/plot of the film. I suggest that you draft your post in Word first and assume that something may go wrong in Canvas when you hit 'Post Reply.' I will not count summary of plot/story or information that is not relevant to the prompt/analysis of one scene toward the required 300-word count. **Please identify the time 0(hr):00(min):00(sec) in the film** where the scene you are analyzing begins and concludes from the stream of the film included in the Module. Please do not repost the questions from this prompt into your post.

Your analysis should refer to course materials and reflect on how film style and history function. A post that earns full points will not merely agree with course materials, but will visually illustrate ideas through personal observation. **Do not forget to include embedded media that visualizes the example(s) in your post.** Please make sure that you read all of the posts in your discussion group before posting. I cannot give full points to posts that analyze scenes or shots that have already been selected by another classmate. Please limit your posts to no more than 400 words and 1-2 examples to give others a chance to write about key scenes/shots. **Please resize your screenshots and images to 'Extra Large' in the 'Image Options.'** The 'Image Options' tag appears above or below an image when you click on it while editing in the Rich Content Editor.

**Grading Rubric Checklist for Full Points (Initial Post):**

- Post identifies the time where the scene you are analyzing begins and concludes from the stream of the film included in the Module.

- **Post analyzes no less than one minute and no more than three minutes of one scene.** If you wish to discuss another scene, please do so in your response to another classmate.
- Post addresses materials related to the prompt and course materials.
- Post includes at least two embedded screen captures from the scene you are analyzing. **Please resize your screenshots and images to 'Extra Large' in the 'Image Options.'** The 'Image Options' tag appears above or below an image when you click on it while editing in the Rich Content Editor.
- Post does not analyze a scene previously selected by a classmate earlier in the thread. Sometimes a classmate will post about the scene you are analyzing while you are writing. It happens. Just message me and let me know.
- Post includes an embedded YouTube clip that showcases Michelle Williams any film not covered in the Module or reading.

**Please Resize Your Screen Captures to 'Extra Large'**

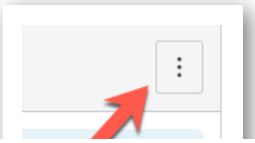
For your **Response Post** to one classmate due by Sunday 7/6 at 11:59pm, please reply in 75 words or more to at least one classmate's post. Responses may include describing your own insight related to the post, providing

additional information from assigned or outside content, disagreeing respectfully by describing your own interpretation, proposing a new idea, or asking a question. I cannot give full points to posts that merely "like" or agree with another post; the response post must demonstrate substantial effort. Please try to respond to a classmate who has not yet received a response.

- Please choose one scene from *My Week With Marilyn* and **embed at least two (2) screenshots** from the scene into your post. Please describe how the cinematography and mise-en-scène in the scene affects how we perceive Williams's performance. Do other formal elements (e.g. editing, sound) of the scene inform how we perceive Williams's performance? I suggest you review (pp. 266-272) for some examples of how filmmaking affects the perception or value of acting: how do appropriateness/transparency and/or inherent thoughtfulness/emotionality affect how we negotiate expressive coherence, wholeness, and unity? What about Williams's performance might we identify as naturalistic, nonnaturalistic, or improvisational? How do we value performance or acting? Are cinematography and mise-en-scène always a factor in how we access film/screen performances? Think about theater acting vs. screen acting (as evidenced in *My Week with Marilyn*).
- In addition, please choose one scene (that someone in the discussion group has not selected and I have not included on the previous page 'Michelle Williams') from another film featuring Williams. Please embed a **YouTube clip** of your selected scene into your post. Please describe how the cinematography and mise-en-scène in the scene affects how we perceive Williams's performance. Does the formal style of the scene inform how we perceive Williams's performance as naturalistic, nonnaturalistic, or improvisational? Some possible films include: *The Station Agent*, *Brokeback Mountain*, *Wendy and Lucy*, *Meek's Cutoff*, *Certain Women*, *Dick*, *Manchester by the Sea*, *Shutter Island*, *Synecdoche*, *New York*, and *I'm Not There*. Please refrain from discussing *Dawson's Creek* or other television performances.

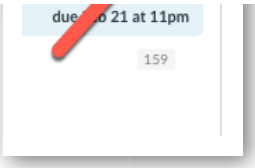
## Discussion Rubric

To view the grading rubric for this discussion, click on the "more options" icon (3 vertical dots at the top) and then select "show rubric".



*Mobile App users:* Click Grades, then click into the

Discussion. The rubric can then be found on the Grades tab.




Aim for excellence! These are the criteria for what comprises an "Excellent" rating for a discussion post:

- Addresses each part of the discussion prompt(s).
- Postings demonstrate reflective and critical thinking, not just recitation of information from textbook.
- Makes connections to previous or current course content, or to real-life situations.
- Contains insightful and thoughtful ideas, connections, or applications.
- Makes reference to textbook or other sources when required.
- Well-written and free of spelling and grammatical errors.
- Includes well-written, thoughtful response(s) to classmates.

Reply

**Joanna Zhou** *(She/Her)* (https://ccsf.instructure.com/courses/66811/users/270480)

Jun 30 7:34pm | Last reply Jul 6 11:11am